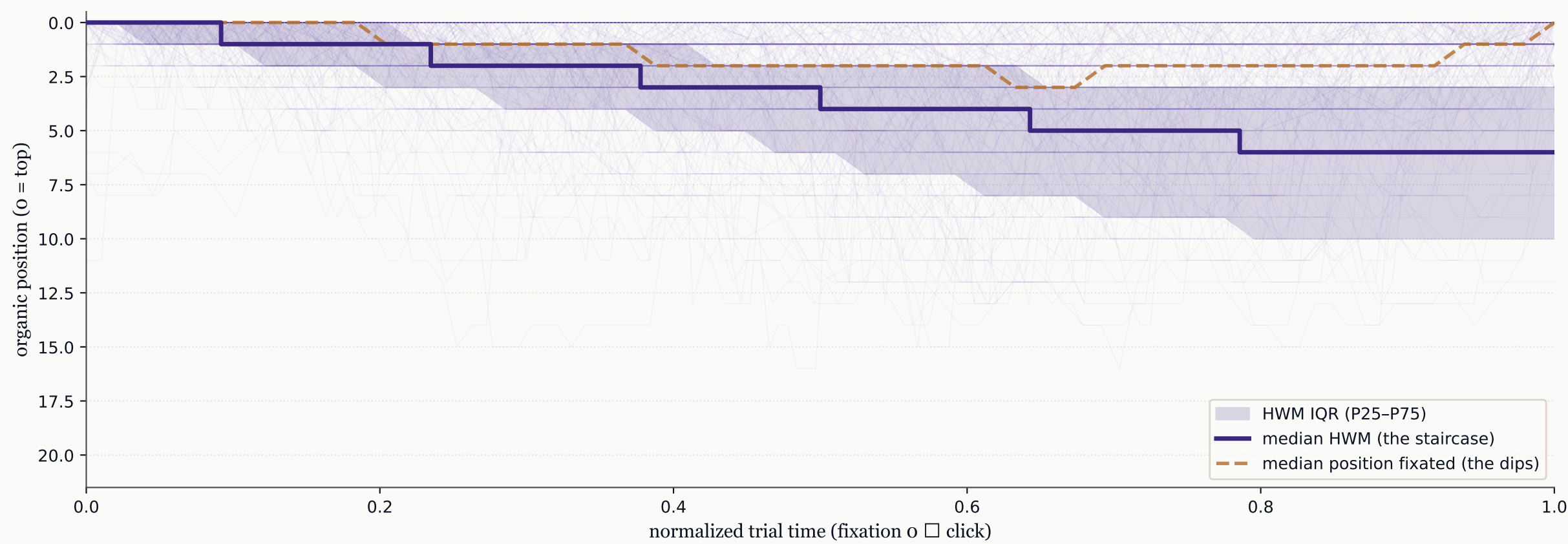


A. The staircase pattern is the population-level scan shape — [organic_hybrid (organic + dd_top + native_ad)] · 2,773 trials · 79% of trials had ≥ 1 regress-scan-regress cycle



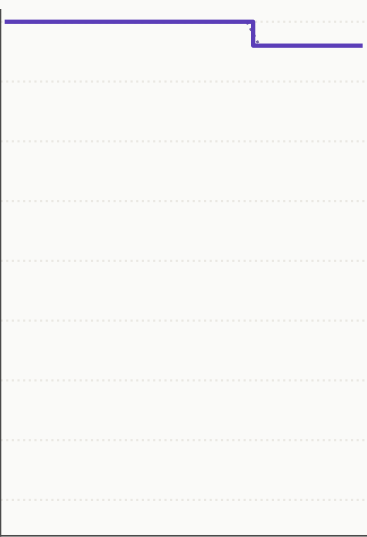
Definition: an "epoch" is a contiguous forward push of the high-water-mark (HWM = deepest rank reached).

A new epoch begins when the user, after regressing below HWM, advances HWM beyond its prior max — i.e., resumes scanning into territory not yet visited.

n_epochs = 1 □ pure forward (any regressions did not later push the HWM further). n_epochs = 2 □ one regress-scan-regress cycle. n_epochs ≥ 3 □ multiple cycles.

B. Small multiples by epoch count — one representative trial per stratum, regression fixations highlighted in orange · dotted line = HWM

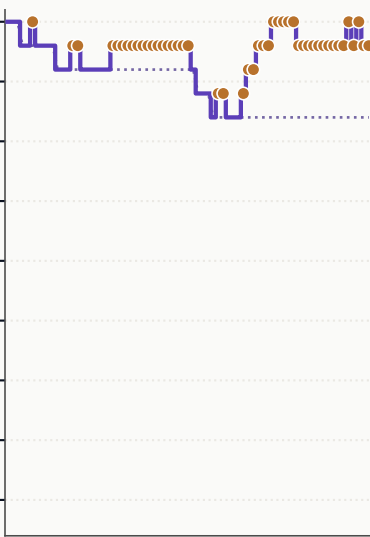
n_epochs = 1
596 trials (21.5%)



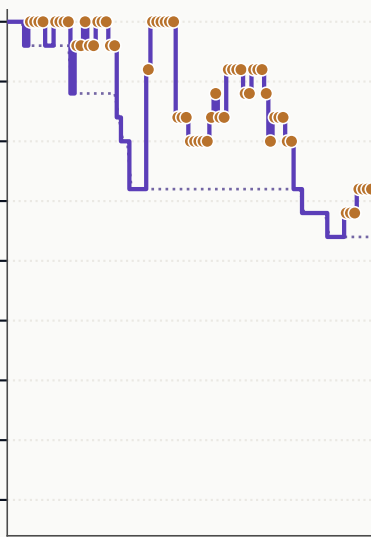
n_epochs = 2
670 trials (24.2%)



n_epochs = 3
590 trials (21.3%)



n_epochs = 4
383 trials (13.8%)



n_epochs = 5+
534 trials (19.3%)

